(F)

→ Belief in modern economic models to apply to primitive societies

→ Assumptions

(i) Principle of utility maximization under scarce means

(ii) Principle of diminishing marginal utility

(iii) Human beings have infinite needs and always desire to gain profit for self.

(S)

Concept of EMBEDDEDNESS

ie economy is embedded in social and kinship based matrix

Primitive societies have economy guided by

(i) Reciprocity

$A \rightleftarrows B$ (Generalised)

$A \rightleftarrows B$ (unbalanced)

(ii) Redistribution

(iii) Primitive markets based on barter

(iv) ceremonial exchange

CASE

(i) Robert Carneiro studied Bushmen (Africa) to find that they work ~3-4 hrs per day despite earning less than their potential.

He concluded that their economic principles are guided by social unity and order in kinship.

(ii) Kula Exchange (Malinowski) where Trobrianders undertake dangerous voyages without any economic gain

(iii) Chenchu tribes don't kill female animals due to fear of their female deity GARELAMA. Also, even during food shortage, a portion is given to deity

CRITICISM

(I) Formalists

→ Sahlins noted that "tribes are optimisers and not maximisers" and said money is of no significance to most primitive societies

→ Prevalence of Barter system among many tribes

eg Kurumba ← TODA ↔ Betta

(II) SUBSTANTIVISTS

→ Platteau criticised that today, no society is completely primitive and conditions of resource scarcity exist everywhere.

→ Due to penetration of money economy, many tribes are directly participating in monetary exchanges
eg] Bondas sell MFPs in weekly haats

As an opposition to two schools, Goddlier and Terry propounded the MARXIST school of economic exchange

Paul and Laura Bohanan, during their study of Tiv (Nigeria) noted that there is a shift towards formalism due to rising globalisation

Today, the debate has lost its prominence due to an integrated approach. Amartya Sen's 'welfare economics' can be of help to understand primitive economy.

Marks: Comment:
Intro:
Body:
Conclusion:
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